of true and false religions, and heresy are embedded in the Christian understanding of toleration, with toleration here not being the same as acceptance, mutual respect or pluralism. Second, toleration of false religions and heretics was not the product of secular liberal thinking but was the restatement of the will of God, the Christian God, that no conscience should be coerced even if it desecrated the will of God. Third, while the 'sword of coercion' was forbidden by God, the 'Sword of Gods spirit', namely the Word of God or the gospel was certainly permissible. The gospel was believed to be 'soul-piercing' and 'soul-saving', and therefore, the alternative to coercion was proselytisation, which was deemed benign, biblically sanctioned and even mandated. Thus, even here, it was Christian liberty at play with the end goal being realisation of God's will on earth. In light of this, there is no escaping the fact that the Enlightenment's 'toleration' was a secularised fulfillment of a true Christian's obligation, namely conversion for reformation of both Christians and non-Christians. The political theology of the Protestant Reformation could not have been written clearer on the walls of the Enlightenment project.

It is precisely for these reasons that De Roover calls both secularism and liberalism secularised versions of Christian onto-epistemology, obscured by the employment of secularism itself as a filter to understand history. De Roover is not alone in holding this view. There are others, such as Carl L. Becker, S.J. Barnett and Elizabeth S. Hurd, who believe that at the very least the evidence to support the common assumption that the Enlightenment was a move away from Christianity towards secular reason is as far as it can get from being conclusive. That the secularisation of the Enlightenment is perhaps the consequence of a retrospective approach to history, appears to be the more plausible argument. This is because several of the leading Enlightenment thinkers were pious Christians in a society heavily committed to Christianity, whose philosophies were significantly more influenced by Christian thought than they were comfortable admitting. This may be because 'orthodoxy' was passé and it was more acceptable to speak out against orthodoxy in favour of the new, the 'modern', even in the context of Christianity, which only proves that even the challenge to Christian orthodoxy was a conversation *within* Christianity and not outside of it.[30] In fact, scholars believe that the views of such thinkers were effectively a manifestation of their desire for a 'different kind